Table 2.1 Early concepts of unmanned aerial vehicles (UAVs).

Period/year	Concept/ development	Inventor/ developer	Technological principle	Significance/ contribution
Pre-1900s	Tethered balloons and kites	Various (France, China, United Kingdom)	Manual aerial observation platforms using tethered lift.	Represented the earliest unmanned systems used for reconnaissance and meteorological observation.
1898	Radio-controlled boat prototype	Nikola Tesla (United States)	Wireless control through electromagnetic transmission.	Introduced the principle of remote control, laying the groundwork for future UAV communication systems.
1916	*Aerial Target*	A. M. Low (United Kingdom)	Radio-guided powered aircraft.	First demonstration of controlled unmanned flight; prototype for future UAVs.